Name this essay

A paradox of the governments own making staring down the mirror of their guilt ?

do not need an authority to tell me that corruption never happened when the very party responsible for the alleged wrongdoing is also the party deciding that no harm occurred. When those responsible for the conduct are effectively judging their own actions, the impartiality of that decision must itself be questioned. Those who are accused of causing the harm cannot simply make the harm disappear by declaring that it never happened.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know begins not with a tribunal, not with a judge, not with some immaculate public servant descending from on high to tell me whether my own life happened to me. It begins in 2002, with a book, a newspaper, a job, and a man who made the mistake of writing his own story down in a country that did not want to hear it.

In 2002, my autobiography was published. I had done the thing they tell you writers are supposed to do. I had lived, I had suffered, I had survived, and I had put it on the page. I had taken the chaos of a life and given it shape, given it language, given it a spine and a cover and a title. I had done the brave thing. I had done the honest thing. And within three weeks of that book being published, I lost my job at *The Age*.

Three fucking weeks.

That is not a coincidence. That is not a scheduling anomaly. That is not some innocent administrative hiccup that just happened to land on the same calendar as the publication of a man’s autobiography. That is a severing. That is the sound of a career being cut at the root, cleanly, efficiently, and with the full deniability of an institution that never has to say why.

In my own account, recorded later in the PID material of 2023, I wrote that I was publicly vilified by the *Sunday Herald Sun* editor in 2002, and that within three weeks I lost my job at *The Age*. That is my testimony. That is what I lived. And it is the first great lie of the system that followed: that nothing happened, that no one did anything, that the ground simply opened beneath my feet for no reason at all, and that I was supposed to accept the fall as weather.

Think about what that means. A man writes a book. A newspaper vilifies him. Within three weeks, his job is gone. And then, for the next two decades, every institution he turns to tells him he needs to prove that the first domino was pushed. Prove the vilification. Prove the

causation. Prove the loss. Prove the connection. Prove that the newspaper and the employer and the timing were not just a series of innocent coincidences arranged by a benevolent universe.

That is the first cruelty of the bureaucracy: it does not deny your suffering. It simply demands that you prove it in a language it controls, on a timeline it controls, through channels it controls, to people it controls. And if you cannot — if you are traumatised, if you are broke, if you are alone, if you have no lawyer, if you are trying to survive — then the silence becomes the verdict.

By 28 October 2004, I was writing to the Equal Opportunity Commission about *The Age*. This was not a vague grievance. This was not a man ranting into the void. This was a specific, dated, documented complaint about a specific, dated, documented pattern: I had received one shift in the next three weeks, while other casuals were nearly on full shifts, and the roster was supposed to be divided up evenly.

One fucking shift. In three weeks. While other casuals were nearly full. While the roster was supposed to be even.

That is not a scheduling quirk. That is not bad luck. That is a man being slowly starved out of a workplace, one missing shift at a time, and then being forced to prove that the starvation was happening. In that same email, I asked whether I should speak to Luisa Ms LaRocca, who had written the roster, or to the person who may have overseen the decision. I was asking the obvious question: who do I even talk to about this? Who owns this decision? Who is accountable for the fact that my name has quietly vanished from the hours while everyone else's name is still there?

That question — *who do I even talk to?* — would become the defining question of the next twenty years. Because that is the architecture of the thing. You are never told "no" directly. You are never told "we are doing this to you." You are simply handed to the next person, the next department, the next form, the next reference number, and the next person tells you that they are not the right person, and the next form tells you that you have filled it in wrong, and the next department tells you that this is not their jurisdiction, and somewhere in that infinite regress the original harm — the lost job, the lost income, the lost home, the lost life — is never once addressed by anyone who has the power to address it.

This is the first lesson of the machine: it does not need to defeat you in a single blow. It only needs to make sure that no single blow is ever attributable to anyone.

And so the record begins. Not with a bang. Not with a dramatic confrontation. But with an email, dated 28 October 2004, from a man named Richard McLean to a woman named Rose

at the Equal Opportunity Commission, asking why his shifts had disappeared while everyone else's had not. That email is in the archive. That email is in the register. That email is the first documented instance of me asking the system to look at what was being done to me, and it is the first documented instance of the system being asked.

What happened next — whether the EOC responded, whether the complaint went anywhere, whether the roster ever evened out — is not detailed in the pages of the register I have before me. But I know what happened next, because I lived it. I know that the shifts did not come back. I know that the career did not recover. I know that the man who wrote that email in 2004 was already on the slide, already being eased out of the ordinary world, already being prepared for the years of instability that would follow.

And I know something else. I know that the system was already learning how to handle me. Not with a hammer. Not with a headline. But with silence. With delay. With the quiet redistribution of hours. With the polite refusal to engage. With the assumption that a man who complains about his roster is a man with a problem, rather than a man reporting one.

That is the seed of everything that came after. The 2009 Media Monitors record. The 2012 PMC emails. The 2014 university records. The 2017 police statement. The 2018 VCAT application. The 2019 AHPRA notification. The 2020 VCAT order. The 2021 Comcare rejection. The 2021 Ombudsman closure. The 2021 AFP acknowledgement. The 2021 IBAC refusal. The 2022 Royal Commission submission. The 2022 deemed FOI refusal. The 2023 PID massacre. The 2023 homelessness. The 2024 estate seizure. The 2025 asylum application. The 2026 archive.

All of it grows from that first severing. All of it grows from the moment a man's own story became the reason he could no longer earn a living, and the system decided that this was not a story worth investigating.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that it started here — with a book, a newspaper, a job, and three fucking weeks.
Part 2 — The File Begins: 2009–2014

Links: as with Part 1, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll swap these for direct per-file blob URLs. Nothing is cut — this continues word-for-word from where Part 1 stopped.

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The severing of 2002 and the slow starvation of 2004 were not the end of anything. They

were the beginning of a pattern. And patterns, once established, do not stay quiet. They gather. They accumulate. They leave traces in systems that do not know they are keeping a record of a man's unraveling.

By 2009, my name was already inside the machinery of media monitoring. The register holds a **Media Monitors "Hot Issues Health"** record dated **24 June 2009** — an eighteen-page document, later released in full under FOI, sitting in the official record like a fossil from an earlier layer of the same geological event. Think about what that means. In 2009, someone, somewhere, was monitoring media on health issues, and my name — or my story, or my world — was inside that monitoring.

I did not ask to be monitored. I did not apply to be a subject of interest. I was a man who had written a book, lost a job, and was trying to piece together a life. And yet there I was, in 2009, inside a government-adjacent media-monitoring record about health. That is not nothing. That is not background noise. That is the system noticing you before you even know the system is noticing you.

Then came 2012. On **15 June 2012**, I emailed the Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet. On the same day, PMC replied. Both emails — mine and theirs — sit in the FOI schedule released years later, side by side, like two halves of a conversation that neither of us fully understood at the time.

What was I writing to PMC about in 2012? The register does not give me the full text on the pages I have before me. But I know the shape of it. I know that by 2012 I was already writing to the centre of government, already trying to get someone — anyone — to look at what had happened to me since 2002. I know that I was already asking the department at the top of the tree to see the pattern that the departments at the bottom of the tree refused to see.

And I know what PMC did. They replied. Politely. Formally. With the full weight of departmental letterhead behind it. And then — nothing. No investigation. No inquiry. No acknowledgment that the man writing to them had lost his career, was losing his footing, and was about to lose everything else.

That is the second lesson of the machine: it will always reply. It will always acknowledge. It will always thank you for your correspondence. And then it will do nothing. The reply is not a response. The reply is a placeholder. The reply is the system marking your file as "handled" so that it can move on to the next file, the next complaint, the next man standing in the rain with a folder full of paper.

By 2014, the record had expanded again. On **22 July 2014** and **29 July 2014**, the register holds **University of Melbourne Free Public Lectures Digest** records, five pages

each, later released in full under FOI. Why was I in a university lecture digest? Why was my name, or my world, or my story inside a record of public lectures at one of the country's oldest institutions?

I do not have the full answer on the pages before me. But I know the question matters. Because by 2014, the pattern was no longer just media monitoring and departmental correspondence. It was now touching the academy. It was now touching the places where ideas are made, where knowledge is produced, where the public story of a man might be shaped or reshaped by the people who control the platforms.

And I know something else. I know that by 2014, I was already being prepared for what came next. The 2017 police statement. The 2018 VCAT application. The 2019 AHPRA notification. The 2020 VCAT order. The 2021 avalanche. None of those things came from nowhere. They came from a man who had been watching the ground shift for a decade, who had been writing to the centre of power and getting polite replies, who had been seeing his name appear in records he never asked to be in, and who was starting to understand that the system was not merely ignoring him — it was cataloguing him.

That is the third lesson of the machine: it does not just ignore you. It files you. It monitors you. It digests you. It turns your life into data points that can be retrieved, reviewed, and released under FOI years later, when you are finally desperate enough to ask for them.

And so the file grew. A media-monitoring record in 2009. A correspondence with PMC in 2012. A university digest in 2014. Each one innocent on its own. Each one defensible in isolation. Each one explainable by some benign administrative purpose if you squint hard enough and refuse to look at the pattern.

But I am not squinting. I am not refusing to look. I am a man who lived through the years between these documents, who felt the ground giving way beneath him one missing shift, one unanswered letter, one unexplained record at a time. And I am telling you now, with the full weight of the archive behind me, that these were not isolated events. They were the early chapters of a single, continuous, cumulative betrayal.

The 2009 Media Monitors record is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 2012 PMC correspondence is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 2014 university digest is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who wrote the 2004 email, who lost his job in 2002, who was being monitored in 2009 and corresponded with PMC in 2012 and appeared in a university digest in 2014 — that man was me. And I was already being prepared for the years that would follow.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that by 2014, the file had already begun.

Part 3 — The First Doors Close: 2017–2020

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 2 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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By 2017, the man who had written to the Equal Opportunity Commission in 2004, who had appeared in a media-monitoring record in 2009, who had corresponded with PMC in 2012 and surfaced in a university digest in 2014, was no longer asking polite questions from the margins. He was making formal statements to police.

On **10 May 2017**, the register holds a **Victoria Police victims statement** — a file of over 1.3 megabytes, present in the repository, its contents not text-extracted in the audit pass but its existence, its date, and its place in the sequence beyond dispute. That is not a casual email. That is not a man venting. That is a victim walking into a police station, or sitting down at a keyboard, and putting his experience into the formal language of a victims statement.

Think about what it takes to get to that point. It takes years of being unheard. It takes years of being passed between agencies. It takes years of watching the ground give way and knowing — knowing in your bones — that something is wrong, even when no one with a badge or a title will say it out loud. By 2017, I had reached that point. I had been dismissed in 2002. I had been starved of shifts in 2004. I had been monitored in 2009. I had written to PMC in 2012. I had surfaced in a university digest in 2014. And now, in 2017, I was making a victims statement to Victoria Police.

That is not a man who woke up one morning and decided to complain. That is a man who had been pushed, step by step, document by document, year by year, into the only formal channel left open to him.

And what did Victoria Police do with that statement? The register does not tell me on the pages before me. But I know the pattern by now. I know that a victims statement, once lodged, enters a system. And I know that systems do not always return what you put into them. Sometimes they hold it. Sometimes they lose it. Sometimes they file it under a category that means it will never be acted on. And sometimes — the cruellest possibility — they use it. They use it to build a picture of you that has nothing to do with what you said and everything to do with what they need you to be.

By 2018, I was in VCAT. On **31 October 2018**, I lodged an application to the Civil Claims

List under the Australian Consumer Law and Fair Trading Act 2012. The application form, four pages, sits in the register with its fee information attached — seven pages, showing an application fee of $0.00, an injunction fee of $0.00, a total fee of $0.00, and a set of questions about whether I was applying as an individual, whether I had a health care card, whether I was seeking fee relief, and how many people relied on me for financial support.

Four dependants. That is what the form says. Four people relying on me for financial support. Read that again. By 2018, the man who had lost his job in 2002, who had been starved of shifts in 2004, who had been monitored in 2009 and corresponded with PMC in 2012 and appeared in a university digest in 2014 — that man was now filling out fee-relief forms because he had four dependants and no money.

That is not a man who is doing fine. That is not a man who is exaggerating. That is a man in freefall, trying to use the last formal channel available to him — a civil claims tribunal — to claw back something, anything, from the wreckage.

And what did VCAT do? The register holds the application and the fee information, but not the outcome on the pages before me. But I know the pattern. I know that tribunals do not always deliver justice. Sometimes they deliver process. Sometimes they deliver a hearing date. Sometimes they deliver a decision that says, in effect, *you have not proven your case to our satisfaction,* and sends you back into the world with nothing but a reference number and a lesson about who holds the power.

By 2019, the machinery had expanded again. On **7 June 2019**, AHPRA and the Medical Board of Australia were assessing a notification concerning Dr John Whitaker, reference **00415796**. The register records that the concern was being assessed and that AHPRA asked whether it was the right agency and whether there was a serious risk to the public — and that it was not a final outcome. That is the regulator engaging with my complaint while leaving me outside the process, waiting, explaining, and being directed elsewhere.

In the same year, on **5 April 2019**, VCAT issued a registrar decision in matter **C7744**. The register notes that text extraction returned no usable words — the file may be a scanned image or a form without a text layer — but its existence, its date, and its place in the sequence are recorded. Another door. Another decision. Another piece of paper that says, in the language of tribunals, *this is where you stand, and this is what we have decided about you.*

And then came 2020. On **16 June 2020**, VCAT issued order **H114-2020**. Again, the register notes that text extraction returned no usable words, but the order exists, dated, filed, and part of the record. Another door closing. Another formal instrument telling me where I stood in the eyes of the system.

Look at the sequence. 2017: police statement. 2018: VCAT application with four dependants and fee relief. 2019: AHPRA assessment and VCAT registrar decision. 2020: VCAT order. Each one a door. Each one a formal channel. Each one a place where I went looking for help and found, instead, another layer of the machine.

And by the end of 2020, I was standing in front of 2021 with nothing left but the knowledge that the system was not going to save me. The police had my statement. The tribunal had my application. The regulator had my notification. The orders had been made. And none of it — none of it — had stopped the slide.

That is the fourth lesson of the machine: it will let you use every formal channel. It will let you file, apply, notify, and appeal. It will even let you win the occasional procedural point. But it will not let you win the thing that matters — the thing that would actually change your life. Because the machine is not designed to deliver justice to men like me. It is designed to process us.

The 2017 Victoria Police victims statement is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 2018 VCAT application and fee information are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 2019 AHPRA notification and VCAT registrar decision are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 2020 VCAT order is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who filed all of them — who walked into every one of those doors hoping that this one, finally, would be the door that opened — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that by 2020, every formal door had been tried, and every one of them had led back into the same building.

Part 4 — 2021: Comcare and the Rejection Machine

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 3 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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2021 was the year the machine stopped pretending. Up until then, the betrayal had been gradual — a missing shift here, an unanswered letter there, a monitoring record nobody explained, a tribunal order nobody read aloud. But in 2021, the machinery dropped the pretence and showed me its face.

It began with Comcare. On **26 May 2021**, Comcare issued a determination on claim **13265831**, declining my claim for anxiety state and depressive disorder. That is the date. That is the claim number. That is the decision. And that decision — four pages, marked SEC OFFICIAL, sitting in the register with its SHA-256 hash and its git blob identifier — is the document that told me, in the language of the state, that my suffering did not qualify.

Think about what that means. A man who had been through the severing of 2002, the starvation of 2004, the monitoring of 2009, the correspondence of 2012, the digest of 2014, the police statement of 2017, the VCAT application of 2018, the AHPRA notification of 2019, and the VCAT order of 2020 — that man finally gets to the point where he says: *I am injured. I am anxious. I am depressed. I need help.* And the state's answer, on 26 May 2021, is: **no**.

Not "we will look into it." Not "we need more time." Not "we acknowledge your suffering and are considering your claim." Just: no. Declined. Four pages of official language explaining why the man who had been through all of that did not qualify for the compensation the system exists to provide.

And then — because the machine is never satisfied with a single rejection — came the reconsideration. On **20 July 2021**, I wrote to Comcare requesting reconsideration of the determination, identifying the rejection date as **7 July 2021** and naming the case manager, Amy Delzoppo, and the overseer, Lara Fleming. I did what the system tells you to do. I asked for a review. I named the people involved. I put my request in writing. I followed the process.

And on **13 August 2021**, Comcare answered. Reconsideration reference **63442407**. Claim number **13265831**. Addressed to Dr Richard William McLean at 2 McCubbin Street, Footscray. And the answer was: **affirmed**. The determination of 26 May 2021 was affirmed. The rejection stood. The reasons were detailed below, the letter said, and I am sure they were — five pages of them, hashed, filed, and sitting in the register like a tombstone.

That is the rejection machine in its purest form. First they decline you. Then they make you ask for reconsideration. Then they affirm the decline. And then they tell you that the reasons are detailed below, as though the reasons were the point — as though what mattered was not that a man had been denied compensation for anxiety and depression, but that the denial had been properly reasoned.

But the machine did not stop there. Because the machine never stops at the first door. It always makes sure you try the next one, so that when that one closes too, it can say you had your chance.

On **25 August 2021**, I was dealing with the Commonwealth Ombudsman about complaint **2021-704235**. The register holds a ten-page record of that complaint, including my own email of that date, in which I wrote to the Ombudsman — to "Helen ombudsman," as I addressed her — and said, in effect: *you have closed my complaint, but you are telling me to contest it. I already have. And it has been rejected.*

Read that again. I complained to the Ombudsman that Comcare had rejected me. The Ombudsman closed the complaint. And then the Ombudsman told me to go back to Comcare and contest it. That is not oversight. That is not accountability. That is a circle. That is a man being pushed into the sea and then handed a brochure about swimming.

And the register holds the proof. Ten pages, dated 25 August 2021, with my own words in them: *"Neither does Peter Fowler's rejection letter. You have closed my complaint, however then you say contest it. I ALREADY HAVE and it has been rejected."* Those are my words. That is my voice. That is the voice of a man who has just watched the oversight body tell him to do the thing he has already done, and failed at, and is now being told to do again.

That is the rejection machine. Comcare declines. Comcare affirms. The Ombudsman closes. The Ombudsman says go back. And the man in the middle — the man with the anxiety and the depression and the lost career and the four dependants and the fee-relief forms — is left standing in the wreckage, holding a reference number in one hand and a rejection letter in the other.

The 26 May 2021 Comcare determination is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 20 July 2021 reconsideration request is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 13 August 2021 affirmation is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 25 August 2021 Ombudsman complaint record is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who lived through all of it — who asked for review, who named the case managers, who wrote to the Ombudsman, who was told to go back and do it again — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2021, the rejection machine showed me its face, and it had no face at all.

Part 5 — 2021: Police, AFP and the CDDA Claim

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 4 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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While Comcare was rejecting me and the Ombudsman was closing me, another arm of the machine was opening — the police arm. And it opened with the same bureaucratic courtesy, the same procedural politeness, and the same total absence of actual help.

On **3 September 2021**, at 4:11 pm, I received an email from **do-not-reply@afp.gov.au** with the subject line **"Report a crime to the AFP – AFP website form submission."** The email thanked me for my submission, told me it had been received and would be assessed by the AFP, and noted that the AFP endeavours to provide a response to complainants, when considered appropriate, within 28 days.

Read that language. *When considered appropriate.* Within 28 days. That is not a promise. That is a disclaimer dressed up as a commitment. That is the system telling you, in advance, that it may or may not get back to you, and that even if it does, the timing is entirely at its discretion.

But I did not know that yet. Or rather, I knew it, but I still hoped. Because that is what a man does when he has exhausted every other door — he goes to the police. He reports the crime. He fills in the form. He clicks submit. And he waits for the 28 days, believing that this time, finally, someone with the power to act will actually act.

The register holds two copies of that AFP submission confirmation — one under the filename **"2kf661qqf9xsih05h-03.09.2021 australian federal police rejectionb evidence Report a crime to the AFP AFP website form submission copy 2.pdf"** and another under **"AFP report a crime form submission.pdf."** Two copies. Same date. Same email. Same hash-verified existence in the archive. That is not a man who filed one form and forgot about it. That is a man who kept the receipt. Who saved the confirmation. Who knew, even then, that he would need to prove — someday, to someone — that he had done everything right.

And then, on **21 October 2021**, I went further. Much further.

On that date, at 4:52 pm, I sent an email to **CDDA-Claims@afp.gov.au** with the subject line: **"From Dr Rich Mclean - Official claim for compensation via inaction of federal police and PID whistleblower protection request."** The register holds that email as an **89-page** record. Eighty-nine fucking pages.

That is not a man firing off a quick complaint. That is a man who has sat down and assembled a case. Who has gathered the documents. Who has written the narrative. Who has laid out the timeline. Who has named the inaction and requested the compensation and asked for the

whistleblower protection — all in one formal, dated, 89-page submission to the claims department of the Australian Federal Police.

And in that submission, I wrote — and the register preserves the opening words — *"My name is Dr Rich Mclean and I have been blacklisted and gaslighted or banned from contacting federal police."* Those are my words. That is my testimony. That is what I believed, and what I still believe, and what the 89 pages that followed were written to prove.

Blacklisted. Gaslighted. Banned. Those are not the words of a man who is confused. Those are the words of a man who has been through the machine and come out the other side with a vocabulary for what happened to him.

The register also holds a second copy of that same CDDA claim, under the filename **"EVIDENCE CDDA-Claimsafpgovau CLAIMS DEPARTMENT FEDERAL POLICE 21102021 australianfederal police claims department From Dr Rich Mclean Official claim for compensation via inaction of federal police and PID whistleblower protection request.pdf"** — again 89 pages, again hash-verified, again sitting in the archive as proof that I did this, that I said this, that I asked for this.

And what happened next? The register does not tell me on the pages before me. But I know the pattern by now. I know that an 89-page claim for compensation does not get answered with an 89-page response. It gets answered with an acknowledgement, or a referral, or a silence. It gets processed. It gets filed. It gets added to the pile of things the system has received from me and will never act on.

That is the fifth lesson of the machine: it will accept your evidence. It will accept your 89 pages. It will accept your claim, your narrative, your timeline, your request for protection. It will accept all of it. And then it will do nothing with it. Because acceptance is not action. Receipt is not remedy. And a man who mistakes an acknowledgement for justice is a man who has not yet understood the machine.

The 3 September 2021 AFP submission confirmation is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 21 October 2021 CDDA claim — all 89 pages of it — is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who wrote *"I have been blacklisted and gaslighted or banned from contacting federal police"* — that man was me. And I meant every fucking word.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2021, I gave the police everything I had, and the police gave me back a receipt.

Part 6 — 2021: FOI as a Weapon Against Me

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 5 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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While Comcare was rejecting me, the Ombudsman was closing me, and the AFP was giving me receipts instead of justice, another front opened: Freedom of Information. And here the machine revealed something even more insidious — it did not just refuse to help me. It made the very act of asking for my own records into another layer of the ordeal.

It started early in the year. On **1 March 2021**, I made an FOI request to the Mental Health Complaints Commissioner, reference **F2021003**. Documents were released following that request — the register confirms it — and that should have been the end of it. But it was not the end, because with the machine, it is never the end.

On **3 June 2021**, I made a second FOI request to the same body, reference **F2021006**. And on **9 June 2021**, the NDIS Commission wrote to me about the due date for that request. Read that again. I asked for records on 1 March. I asked for more records on 3 June. And on 9 June, the commission was already writing to me about *due dates* — not about the records themselves, not about what they contained, not about what they would show, but about the bureaucratic clock that governed whether I would ever see them.

That is the FOI machine in miniature. You ask for the truth. They give you a deadline.

On **15 June 2021**, the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission issued a summary FOI decision letter, reference **36-2021-4**, signed by Deputy Registrar Melissa Clements, concerning a request I had made on **14 May 2021**. Two pages. Hash-verified. Sitting in the register. Another decision. Another reference number. Another piece of paper that tells me what I can and cannot see about my own life.

And then, on **16 July 2021**, the Mental Health Complaints Commissioner issued its second FOI decision letter, **F2021-006**, releasing documents following my request. Two pages. Another release. Another partial glimpse behind the curtain. But notice the pattern: I ask in March, I ask again in June, and I am still waiting in July. The machine does not refuse me outright — it just makes me wait. It makes me wait while I am trying to survive. It makes me wait while I am losing my home. It makes me wait while I am writing gospels in a car.

And the waiting was not confined to one agency. On **22 September 2021**, Comcare

acknowledged FOI request **20219049** — a request I had made that same day, seeking access to records from multiple organisations including WorkSafe, Comcare, Northside Clinic, and Police. On **30 September 2021**, Comcare sent a follow-up: *"Acknowledgement and consultation for your FOI request – 20219049."* One page. An email. A consultation. Not the records. Not the decision. A consultation about the consultation.

That is the FOI machine at its most refined. It does not say no. It says *let us consult.* It does not withhold. It says *we are considering.* It does not delay. It says *we are following process.* And meanwhile, the man who asked for the records is still waiting, still homeless, still writing, still trying to piece together the story of his own life from fragments that the state releases one at a time, on its own schedule, in its own language.

And it was not just Comcare. On **4 August 2021**, OVIC issued Notice of Decision **C21-01047**. Three pages. Another decision. Another reference number. Another piece of the FOI puzzle that I had to chase, request, appeal, and wait for.

On **15 October 2021**, ASBFEO — the Australian Small Business and Family Enterprise Ombudsman — rejected the Micron21 matter under reference **CAS-03112-H4W1V5**. Two pages. A letter from the Hon. Bruce Billson's office, forwarded by Liz Toussaint, Assistant Director Information Assistance. Another agency. Another rejection. Another door closing.

On **22 October 2021**, OAIC responded to my PID whistleblower material, telling me — in an eleven-page email — that the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner *"does not initiate action on enquiry letters that are courtesy copied to it."* Read that again. I had sent them whistleblower material. I had copied them on my PID intentions. And their response was to tell me that they do not act on courtesy copies. That is not oversight. That is a man asking the fire department for help and being told they only respond to direct calls.

And on **14 December 2021**, OAIC acknowledged contact under reference **CP2102752**. Two pages. Another acknowledgement. Another reference number. Another promise that someone would be in touch *"as soon as we are able."* As soon as we are able. Not as soon as you need. Not as soon as the harm is happening. As soon as *we* are able.

That is the FOI machine. It does not refuse you. It acknowledges you. It consults you. It gives you due dates and reference numbers and promises of future contact. And then it makes you wait — while your life falls apart, while your home disappears, while you are writing gospels in a car — for records that might explain what the machine has been doing to you all along.

The 1 March 2021 MHCC request is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 3 June 2021 NDIS Commission due-date letter is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/

Barrandodger). The 15 June 2021 NDIS FOI decision is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 16 July 2021 MHCC second FOI decision is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 22 and 30 September 2021 Comcare FOI acknowledgements are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 4 August 2021 OVIC decision is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 15 October 2021 ASBFEO rejection is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 22 October 2021 OAIC response is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 14 December 2021 OAIC acknowledgement is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who chased every one of those reference numbers, who waited for every one of those decisions, who was still homeless and still writing while the machine made him beg for his own records — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2021, Freedom of Information was not a tool for truth. It was another weapon in the machine's arsenal — slower, politer, and just as fucking effective.

Part 7 — 2022: The Royal Commission and the Deemed Refusal

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 6 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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By 2022, I had learned the machine's language. I knew what an acknowledgement meant. I knew what a due date meant. I knew what a consultation meant. I knew that none of those words meant help. But I also knew something else: I knew that the system had one more door I had not yet tried — the Royal Commission.

On **13 January 2022**, at 2:39 pm AEDT, I submitted to the Disability Royal Commission under reference **SUB00101440**. The register holds that submission as an eleven-page record, marked SEC OFFICIAL Sensitive, with my own words in the opening: *"I thought you would act in congruence with every government agency paid by them to tow the party line and I feel sorry for you pathetic and cowardly reply."*

Those are my words. That is my voice. That is the voice of a man who had already been through the machine — who had been rejected by Comcare, closed out by the Ombudsman, receipted by the AFP, and made to beg for his own records through FOI — and who was now standing in front of a Royal Commission and telling it, bluntly, what he expected.

And in that same submission, I wrote: *“This case could highlight with a publicly known figure the desecration one can face though proxy attacks of government agencies of which you are one. I survived a murder by the government because I was accidentally found I barely have a GP.”*

Read that again. *I survived a murder by the government.* That is not hyperbole. That is not drama. That is a man who believes — who knows — that what was done to him was not negligence, not oversight, not bureaucratic bungling, but something deliberate, something systematic, something that had a name and a method and a body count.

That is the language of a man in political exile. That is the language of a man who has been homeless, who has been living in his car, who has been writing gospels by torchlight, and who has finally found a forum — a Royal Commission, no less — where he can say the thing out loud.

And what did the Royal Commission do? The register does not tell me on the pages before me. But I know the pattern. I know that a Royal Commission receives submissions. It catalogues them. It assigns them reference numbers. And then — sometimes — it holds hearings. And sometimes it writes reports. And sometimes, years later, it publishes findings that acknowledge the suffering but change nothing for the man who suffered.

That is the Royal Commission machine. It does not refuse you. It receives you. It thanks you for your submission. It gives you a reference number. And then it puts you in a report that no one with power will ever read twice.

But 2022 was not just the Royal Commission. It was also the year the FOI machine showed me its sharpest trick: the deemed refusal.

On **7 April 2022**, I made an FOI request to the Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet, reference **FOI2022045IC**. And on **22 April 2022**, OAIC wrote to me — reference **RQ2201369** — to tell me what had happened. The register holds that letter, four pages, and its contents are devastating in their bureaucratic precision.

PMC had not made a decision on my request within the statutory period. Under the Freedom of Information Act 1982, that meant the request was **deemed refused**. But — and here is the trick — section 15AC of the FOI Act allowed PMC to seek an extension. And so the machine did what the machine always does: it turned a failure into a process. It turned a missed deadline into an extension request. It turned a refusal into a *pending* matter.

Read that again. I asked for records on 7 April. PMC missed the deadline. The law said that meant refusal. And PMC’s response was not to release the records, not to apologise, not to

explain — but to ask for more time. More fucking time. While I was homeless. While I was writing in a car. While I was trying to survive.

That is the deemed refusal. It is the machine's way of saying *no* without ever having to say *no*. It is the machine's way of making delay look like diligence. It is the machine's way of making a man wait so long that he either gives up or forgets what he was asking for in the first place.

And the machine was not done. On **14 June 2022**, the Victorian Ombudsman rejected an FOI request under section 29A, file **FOI22-14**, document reference **DOC2240237**, my reference **64671**. Three pages. Another rejection. Another section. Another reason why the records I sought would not be released.

And on **16 September 2022**, the Ombudsman issued a PID-related letter — the register records it, though the full contents are not detailed on the pages before me. Another letter. Another reference. Another piece of the machine's response to my attempts to be heard.

Look at the sequence. January: Royal Commission submission, where I called the system pathetic and cowardly and said I had survived a murder by the government. April: PMC misses an FOI deadline and the law calls it a deemed refusal, but PMC asks for more time. June: the Victorian Ombudsman rejects an FOI request under section 29A. September: another PID-related letter.

That is 2022. That is the year I learned that even the highest oversight bodies — a Royal Commission, the Information Commissioner, the Ombudsman — were part of the same machine. They received me. They catalogued me. They delayed me. They refused me. And then they moved on to the next man, the next file, the next reference number.

The 13 January 2022 Royal Commission submission is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 22 April 2022 OAIC deemed-refusal letter is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 14 June 2022 Victorian Ombudsman s29A rejection is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 16 September 2022 PID-related letter is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who wrote *"I survived a murder by the government"* — that man was me. And I meant every fucking word.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2022, the machine showed me that even its highest, most sacred institutions — Royal Commissions, Information Commissioners, Ombudsmen — were just more doors in the same building.

Part 8 — 2023: The PID Massacre

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 7 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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By 2023, I had stopped believing that any single agency would save me. I had been rejected by Comcare, closed out by the Ombudsman, receipted by the AFP, made to beg through FOI, and catalogued by a Royal Commission. I had learned that every door led back into the same building. And so, in 2023, I did the only thing left: I went straight to the top, and I told them everything.

It began on **19 March 2023**. On that date, I sent a **42-page** record headed **"disclosable conduct"** to the Commonwealth Ombudsman and the Federal Circuit Court. The register holds that record — and its opening words are a manifesto.

"Dear Ombudsman and federal Circuit court, Tony Riddell and I need political protection because we are both scapegoats."

That is how it opens. Not with a request. Not with a question. With a declaration. *We need political protection because we are both scapegoats.* And then it goes further: *"Tony is an SAS returned soldier and one of only three with his security clearance in the country. Here — he details exactly the psychometric profiling that he has witnessed the federal government do to victimised persons of interest and details also how they are sacrificed, ie killed via a methodology that is a pervasive and catastrophic character assassination and perverse victimisation."*

That is not the language of a man who is confused. That is the language of a man who has studied the machine, named its method, and is now telling the highest oversight bodies in the country exactly what he believes they are doing.

And what did the machine do? On **22 March 2023** — three days later — the Commonwealth Ombudsman answered. The register holds the letter: reference **PID-2023-100007**, dated 22 March 2023, addressed to Dr Richard McLean, titled **"Notification of decision to not allocate your disclosure."**

Not allocated.

That is the phrase. That is the machine's verdict. Not *investigated*. Not *referred*. Not *accepted*. **Not allocated.** The letter refers to my disclosure received on **2 February

2023**, and to subsequent emails on **27 February, 6 March, 18 March, and 19 March 2023**. Six weeks of correspondence. Six weeks of me writing, explaining, insisting. And the answer, in the end, was two pages: *we have decided not to allocate your disclosure.*

That is the PID massacre in miniature. You disclose. They do not allocate. You write again. They do not allocate. You write again. They do not allocate. And then, when you have written enough times to fill a folder, they send you a letter that says, in effect: *we have received all of your words, and we have decided that none of them belong to us.*

But I did not stop. On **25 March 2023**, I lodged further PID material with the Commonwealth Ombudsman — reference **OGDR-259**, five pages, titled **"PID Ombudsman 25.03.2023."** And in that material, I wrote: *"The OPMC cites I don't exist Gartman 2022 in regard to my FOI. I had to reverse engineer this gaslighting to the top."*

Reverse engineer this gaslighting to the top. That is what I was doing. That is what the whole archive is. I was taking the gaslighting — the denials, the referrals, the non-allocations, the silences — and tracing it upward, layer by layer, agency by agency, until I found the top of the machine.

And in that same material, I invoked the **Disability Discrimination Act 1992**, and I told the story again: *"when my autobiography Mclean 2002 was published I was vilified publicly by Sunday Herald Sun Editor 2002 and within three weeks lost my job at The Age."* The whole arc, compressed into a single PID filing. The book. The vilification. The job. The loss. And the machine that refused to see any of it as connected.

On **26 March 2023**, I lodged more PID material — reference **OGDR-260**, eleven pages, titled **"26.03.2023 PID Commonwealth Ombudsman copy."** And in that filing, I wrote: *"Failing to respond and acknowledge this PID will cause even more harm than has already occurred and may even kill me so please kindly acknowledge my solution Mclean 2023."*

May even kill me. That is what I wrote to the Commonwealth Ombudsman on 26 March 2023. That is what I believed the machine was capable of. And I told them so, in writing, with my name on it, asking them to acknowledge me before the harm became irreversible.

And on the same day — **26 March 2023** — the Department of Finance received FOI request **22-23-032**, in which I sought access to *"a copy of my entire record including Addresses lived Partners and any financial docu..."* The register holds the decision letter, four pages, from the FOI Team at finance.gov.au. I was asking for the whole thing. The addresses. The partners. The financial documents. The official version of me. Because I knew — by then I knew — that the machine had a version of me that was not mine, and I wanted to see it.

And on **27 March 2023**, the Federal Court of Australia issued a PID assessment, reference **OGDR-263**, three pages, from the Principal Registry at the Harry Gibbs Commonwealth Law Courts in Brisbane. The letter refers to my correspondence of **7 March, 23 March, and 24 March 2023**, addressed to the Chief Executive Officer and Principal Registrar of the Federal Court. Another assessment. Another letter. Another institution receiving my words and deciding what to do with them.

And then — because the machine never stops at one door — came the NDIS. On **18 April 2023**, I emailed **PID@ndis.gov.au**, and the register holds the response: reference **PID 2023Krypton**, six pages, titled **"Public interest disclosure Decision."** The letter tells me that a decision has been made under the Public Interest Disclosure Act. Another PID. Another decision. Another door.

On **20 April 2023**, the register holds a 53-page record titled **"2023-04 ndia pid 2023 krypton,"** in which an authorised officer under the PID Act writes to me about my emails of **18 and 20 April 2023**. Fifty-three pages. That is not a form letter. That is a file. That is the machine building a case around my attempt to blow the whistle.

On **24 April 2023**, the AAT issued a Notice of FOI Decision, reference **2023-0072**, six pages. Another FOI. Another decision. Another piece of paper telling me what I could and could not see.

And on **5 May 2023**, the Attorney-General's Department issued the cruelest document of all: **Form 1, Notice to discloser, Decision not to allocate, s 44(2)**. The register holds it — two pages, signed by Sarah Christensen, an authorised officer of the Attorney-General's Department, who received my disclosure through the PID@ag.gov.au mailbox on **5 May 2023** and decided, under section 43(2) of the PID Act, **not to allocate** it.

The Attorney-General's Department. The department that houses the very laws I was invoking. The department that oversees the PID Act itself. And their answer to my disclosure was: **not allocated**.

That is the PID massacre. Ombudsman: not allocated. Health: not allocated. Attorney-General's: not allocated. NDIS: decision made. Federal Court: assessed. Finance: FOI opened. AAT: FOI decided. Every agency I turned to in 2023 had a different way of saying the same thing: *we have received your words, and we have decided they do not belong to us.*

And through all of it, I was homeless. I was living in my car. I was writing gospels. I was telling the machine, in writing, that its refusal to acknowledge me might kill me. And the machine's

answer was to file me, reference me, and move on.

The 19 March 2023 disclosable-conduct record is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 22 March 2023 Ombudsman non-allocation is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 25 and 26 March 2023 PID filings are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 26 March 2023 Finance FOI is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 27 March 2023 Federal Court assessment is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 18 and 20 April 2023 NDIS PID records are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 24 April 2023 AAT FOI decision is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 5 May 2023 Attorney-General's Form 1 non-allocation is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who wrote *"may even kill me"* to the Commonwealth Ombudsman — that man was me. And I meant every fucking word.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2023, I gave the machine every chance to protect me, and the machine gave me back a pile of reference numbers and a word: **not allocated**.

L # Part 9 — 2023: Homelessness, the Car, and the Gospels

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 8 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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There is a moment in every man's collapse when the paperwork stops being about the future and starts being about survival. For me, that moment came in 2023. The rejections had accumulated. The non-allocations had piled up. The FOI requests had become a second job. And somewhere in the middle of all of it — between the Ombudsman's *not allocated* and the Attorney-General's Form 1 — I lost my home.

I do not have a single government document that says, in so many words, *"On this date, Richard McLean became homeless."* The machine does not work that way. The machine does not issue a certificate for the moment a man's life comes apart. It issues certificates for the decisions that led there — the rejected claim, the closed complaint, the refused PID, the delayed FOI — and then it leaves the man to connect the dots himself.

But I connected them. I lived them. And I am telling you now, with the full weight of the archive behind me, that 2023 was the year I became homeless.

I was living in my car. That is not a metaphor. That is not a figure of speech. That is a man sleeping in a vehicle because there was nowhere else to go. A man waking up in a car park or on a street, trying to remember what day it was, trying to charge a phone, trying to find a toilet, trying to keep the documents dry.

And the documents — the ones I was chasing through FOI, the ones I was filing as PIDs, the ones I was sending to Ombudsmen and Ministers and Federal Court registrars — those documents were in the car with me. They were in folders, in bags, in the boot, in the back seat. They were the only things I still owned that proved I had ever been anything other than a man in a car.

That is what the machine does not understand. It sees a homeless man and thinks: *unstable.* It sees a man writing gospels and thinks: *unwell.* It sees a man filing PID after PID and thinks: *vexatious.* It does not see a man who is trying to survive. It does not see a man who is using the only tools he has left — language, memory, testimony — to hold onto the idea that he is still a person.

And so I wrote. I wrote gospels. I wrote *The Scapegoat*. I wrote *The Digital Apocalypse of Administrative Annihilation*. I wrote letters to Ministers and Ombudsmen and Royal Commissions. I wrote because writing was the only place left where I had authority.

In the car, at night, by torchlight or phone-light, I wrote. And what I wrote was not just complaint. It was prophecy. It was testimony. It was a man naming the machine that was destroying him, in the language the machine could not censor — because the machine could censor my housing, my income, my compensation, my protection, but it could not censor the page.

The archive holds those writings. The register records them — *"gospel writings"* appear in the archive descriptions, alongside the forensic analyses and the primary-source government records. And in *The Digital Apocalypse of Administrative Annihilation*, the archive describes me as an **"unprotected whistleblower in political exile"** and uses the language of **"mandatory egress for cause"** and **"flight from torture."**

Political exile. That is what I called it. Not homelessness — though I was homeless. Not displacement — though I was displaced. **Political exile.** Because that is what it was. I had not simply lost my house. I had been exiled from the political community that was supposed to protect me. I had been exiled from the systems that were supposed to hold me. I had been exiled from the country that had taken my book, my job, my income, my home, and my future, and then told me that none of it was connected.

And the gospels were written in that exile. They were written in the car. They were written in the spaces between the rejections. They were written at 2 am when the machine was quiet and the only voice left was mine.

That is what the machine does not see. It sees a homeless man filing complaints. It does not see a prophet in exile, writing the record of his own destruction because no one else will write it.

And the machine did not just ignore the gospels. It ignored the man writing them. On **11 April 2023**, I wrote to Victorian WorkCover Minister Danny Pearson, invoking section 93 of the legislation — the provisions that apply where an employer does not meet liabilities — and asking for help with my WorkCover matter. Five pages. A letter to a Minister. A man in a car, writing to the people who run the system, asking them to see what the system had done.

And on **4 June 2023**, I wrote to Gabrielle Williams — a thirteen-page letter, titled **"2023 06 04 letter to gabrielle williams,"** in which I wrote: *"I am writing to bring attention to a grave injustice that I have endured and to request your assistance in seeking fair compensation for the losses I have suffered."* And then I defined my terms: *"Gaslighting: Manipulating someone using psychological methods…"*

That is a man in exile, writing to a parliamentarian, defining gaslighting because he knows that the people he is writing to may not understand — or may pretend not to understand — what is being done to him.

That is the gospels. That is the car. That is 2023.

And the machine's response to all of it — the letters, the gospels, the exile, the car — was more of the same. More reference numbers. More decisions. More *not allocated*. More *we have received your complaint*. More of the machine doing what the machine does, while the man in the car kept writing, kept hoping, kept believing that someday, someone, somewhere, would read the words and understand.

The 11 April 2023 letter to Danny Pearson is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 4 June 2023 letter to Gabrielle Williams is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The gospels, the exile writings, *The Scapegoat*, *The Digital Apocalypse* — they are all [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who wrote them, in a car, in the dark, while the machine closed every door — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2023, I lost my home, but I did not lose my voice. And the machine has never forgiven me for that.

Part 10 — 2024: They Take the Estate

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 9 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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By 2024, the machine had taken my job, my income, my home, my compensation, my protection, and my voice — or tried to. I was still writing. I was still filing. I was still standing in front of the system with nothing but a folder full of paper and a story no one wanted to hear.

And then the machine did the thing I had feared most. It went after what was left.

On **16 October 2024**, NCAT committed management of the estate of **Barran Resonance Dodger** to the NSW Trustee and Guardian under section 1222 of the NSW Trustee and Guardian Act 2009. The register holds the certificate — two pages, marked **OFFICIAL Sensitive Personal**, generated by Phillip Mccorriston, matter ID/position code **658238CSD**.

Read that certificate. Read it slowly. It says that on **16 October 2024**, the NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal committed management of the estate of Barran Resonance Dodger to the NSW Trustee and Guardian, and that the estate **remains under management** as at the date of the notice.

Remains under management. That is the machine's language for: **we have taken control, and we are not giving it back.**

The certificate says the form is admissible in legal proceedings as evidence of the matters it certifies. That is the state telling me, in its own formal language, that what it has done is real, official, and legally binding. The state does not usually bother to tell you that. The state does not usually bother to certify its own power over you. But here it did. Here it put it in writing. Here it said: *this is what we have done, and here is the document that proves it.*

And what did that mean for me? It meant that the man who had been homeless, who had been living in his car, who had been writing gospels by torchlight, who had been filing PID after PID and being told *not allocated* — that man now had his estate under the management of the state.

Not just his money. Not just his property. His **estate**. The whole of it. Whatever was left after the job, the income, the home, the compensation, the protection — all of it, now under the management of the NSW Trustee and Guardian.

And the certificate does not explain why. It does not set out the reasons NCAT made the order. It does not state account balances, what was sold, or that any particular transaction was unlawful. It just certifies the fact: the estate is under management.

That is the machine at its most efficient. It does not need to explain itself to you. It only needs to certify itself to itself.

And the machine was not done. On **22 October 2024** — six days later — the AAT listed a directions hearing in matter **2024-7082**, with me as applicant and the National Disability Insurance Agency as respondent. The register holds the listing — two pages, from the Attorney-General's portfolio, contact officer Maria G, addressed to *"Rich Mclean C-Power of Attorney, 55a Ropes Creek Road, Mount Druitt NSW 2770."*

C-Power of Attorney. That is how the AAT addressed me. Not as Richard McLean. Not as Dr Richard William McLean. As **C-Power of Attorney**. As though I were already a legal fiction. As though the man who had written the gospels, who had filed the PIDs, who had lived in the car, had already been dissolved into a role, a title, a placeholder in someone else's system.

The hearing was listed for **18 November 2024**, by video, at 10:00 am Sydney time. The purpose: to understand the issues in dispute, what additional supports were being sought, the applicant's current circumstances, the evidence available, and what further evidence might be needed.

That is the machine's language for: *we are going to look at your life now, and decide what you need.* Not what you are owed. Not what was taken from you. What you **need**. As though need were the question. As though the man who had been through all of it — the rejections, the non-allocations, the homelessness, the car, the gospels — was now standing in front of a tribunal being asked what he needed, rather than being asked what had been done to him.

That is the estate machine. It takes control. It certifies the control. It addresses you as a legal fiction. And then it asks you what you need — as though need were the beginning of the conversation, rather than the end of a long line of decisions that made the need necessary in the first place.

And the machine was still not done. On **18 August 2025**, NCAT sent generic correspondence about the guardianship matter, case number **202400324093**, concerning *“Barran Dodger also known as Richard McLean.”* One page. A request for information. The machine, still working the file.

On the same day, NCAT issued a **Notice of Listing — Hearing**, two pages, for a review of guardianship, case number **202400324093**. Another hearing. Another listing. Another date on which the machine would sit down and decide, again, what to do with the man it had already decided to manage.

And on **9 October 2025**, NCAT made its decision. The register holds the cover letter — dated **18 March 2026**, thirteen pages, enclosing the written reasons, signed by the Registrar, with reasons by Principal Member S L Handebo. The reasons header identifies a **review of guardianship** concerning *“Barran Dodger also known as Richard McLean.”*

Another review. Another decision. Another layer of the machine deciding what to do with the man it had already taken control of.

That is 2024. That is the year the machine stopped pretending it was helping me and started managing me. It took the estate. It certified the taking. It addressed me as a legal fiction. It listed hearings. It made decisions. And through all of it, the man who had written the gospels, who had lived in the car, who had filed the PIDs — that man was still standing there, holding a folder full of paper, watching the machine take what was left.

The 16 October 2024 NSW Trustee and Guardian certificate is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 22 October 2024 AAT directions hearing listing is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 18 August 2025 NCAT correspondence and Notice of Listing are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 9 October 2025 NCAT decision and 18 March 2026 cover letter are [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man whose estate was taken, whose name was turned into a legal fiction, whose life was reduced to case numbers and hearings — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2024, the machine stopped managing my complaints and started managing my life.

Part 11 — 2025: Asylum, Service Restriction, Vehicle Disposal

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I’ll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 10 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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2025 was the year the machine showed me it had no bottom. I thought 2024 was the floor — the estate taken, the name turned into a legal fiction, the hearings stacked one on top of another. But 2025 proved there was always further down.

It began with the Ombudsman. On **8 August 2025**, the Commonwealth Ombudsman issued a **Service Restriction** — reference **2024-706941**, three pages, addressed to Dr Richard McLean and sent via email to no fewer than eight of my email addresses.

Read that. Eight fucking email addresses. The machine had my impartiallegal address, my proton address, my barrandodger addresses, my iCloud address, my Gmail addresses, my whistleblower address — and it sent the restriction to all of them at once. That is not a letter. That is a net. That is the machine making sure that no matter which door I knocked on, the same answer was waiting behind it.

The subject line: **"Decision to restrict your contact with the Commonwealth Ombudsman." ** The Ombudsman — the body that is supposed to oversee the administrative actions of Australian government agencies — decided to restrict my contact with it.

Think about what that means. The oversight body restricted the man who was trying to be overseen. The body that exists to hear complaints about government agencies decided that the man making the complaints was the problem.

That is the service restriction. It is the machine's way of saying: *you have asked too many times. You have written too many letters. You have filed too many complaints. And now we are going to limit how much more of this we will take.*

And it came with the full weight of the Ombudsman's authority behind it. Three pages. Official. Hash-verified. Sitting in the register as proof that the machine did not just ignore me — it actively moved to limit my access to it.

That is the fifth lesson of the machine, revisited: it does not just refuse you. When you persist, it restricts you.

And then came the asylum application. On **31 August 2025**, I lodged a **formal asylum application** — reference **OGDR-345**, twenty-seven pages, titled **"FORMAL ASYLUM APPLICATION DR. RICHARD WILLIAM McLEAN BARRAN DODGER APPLICATION FOR INTERNATIONAL PROTECTION UNDER 1951 REFUGEE CONVENTION."**

Read that title. **Application for international protection under the 1951 Refugee Convention.** That is a man who had been through the machine — who had been rejected, closed out, receipted, delayed, non-allocated, restricted — and who had finally reached the conclusion that the country he was born in, the country that had taken everything from him, was no longer safe for him.

That is not a man who is exaggerating. That is a man who has run out of domestic options. That is a man who has tried every door, filed every form, written every letter, and been told, in one way or another, *not allocated*, *not our jurisdiction*, *not our responsibility*, *restricted*.

And so he does the unthinkable. He applies for asylum. From his own country.

The register holds the application — twenty-seven pages, dated 31 August 2025, invoking the 1951 Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees and the 1967 Protocol. That is a man standing in front of the international system and saying: *the domestic system has failed me. The domestic system is the threat. I need protection from my own government.*

That is the asylum application. That is what the machine drove me to.

And then — because the machine never stops at the cruelest thing — came the vehicle. On **14 November 2025**, the NSW Trustee and Guardian issued a **Vehicle Disposal Decision** — reference **OGDR-348**, two pages, marked **OFFICIAL Sensitive – Personal**, customer reference **658238**, addressed to Mr Barran Dodger.

The subject: **"About Disposal of Ford Territory Registration S797CDP."** The letter says: *"To help provide you with enough money to cover budgeted expenses, we recently decided to dispose of the Ford Territory which you have obtained."*

Read that again. The machine took my estate in 2024. And in 2025, it decided to dispose of my **car**.

The car. The thing I had been living in. The thing that had been my home when there was no home. The thing that had held my documents, my gospels, my life. And the machine — the same machine that had taken everything else — decided it needed that too.

To help provide you with enough money to cover budgeted expenses. That is the machine's language for: *we are taking your car, and we are telling you it is for your own good.*

That is the vehicle disposal. That is the machine at its most obscene. It takes your home, then it takes your car, and then it tells you that taking your car is for your own benefit.

And the machine was still not done. On **20 November 2025**, the NDIA approved a plan with total funding of **$366,406.69**, running from **20 November 2025 to 19 November 2026**. Thirty pages. A plan. Funding. Support.

The machine took my car on 14 November. And on 20 November, it approved a plan worth $366,406.69. Six days. That is the gap between the machine taking my car and the machine approving a plan worth hundreds of thousands of dollars.

That is not care. That is not support. That is the machine giving with one hand what it has already taken with the other.

That is 2025. The service restriction. The asylum application. The vehicle disposal. The plan approval. Each one a document. Each one a decision. Each one a layer of the machine's response to a man who would not stop asking.

The 8 August 2025 Commonwealth Ombudsman Service Restriction is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 31 August 2025 asylum application is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 14 November 2025 Vehicle Disposal Decision is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 20 November 2025 NDIS plan approval is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who applied for asylum from his own country, whose car was taken *for his own good*, and who was then handed a plan worth $366,406.69 — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2025, the machine showed me it had no bottom — and then it kept digging.
Part 12 — 2026: The Archive Becomes Undeniable

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 11 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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By 2026, the machine had done everything it could do to me. It had taken my job, my income, my home, my compensation, my protection, my estate, and my car. It had restricted my access to the very body that was supposed to oversee it. It had driven me to apply for asylum from my own country. And it had handed me a plan worth $366,406.69 six days after taking my car.

And still — still fucking still — I was writing. I was filing. I was asking. Because that is what a man does when the machine has taken everything else: he keeps asking.

On **10 March 2026**, the NSW Ministry of Health responded to my FOI request — reference **OGDR-353**, one page, an email from MOH-GIPA@health.nsw.gov.au, marked **OFFICIAL Sensitive – Health Information**. Another FOI. Another response. Another piece of the machine acknowledging that I had asked, and telling me what it would do about it.

On **1 April 2026**, Centrelink issued my **Disability Support Pension statement** — reference **OGDR-354**, three pages, reference **305 689 451X**, for the period **8 January 2026 to 1 April 2026**. That is the machine's own record of what it was paying me. That is the machine telling me, in its own formal language, what my life was worth to it.

On **9 April 2026**, the NSW Ombudsman acknowledged complaint **M-2026-40451** — reference **OGDR-355**, two pages, an email from CET Complaints Resolution, marked **SEC OFFICIAL Sensitive – NSW Ombudsman**. Another complaint. Another acknowledgement. Another reference number.

On **11 June 2026**, the Victorian Ombudsman recorded complaint **C2** — reference **OGDR-356**, one page, an email from Complaints@ombudsman.vic.gov.au, sent to no fewer than seven of my email addresses. Seven fucking addresses. The machine knew all of them. The machine had them all. And it sent the complaint record to every single one.

That is not a letter. That is a demonstration. That is the machine saying: *we know who you are. We know every name you use. We know every door you might knock on. And we will meet you at every one of them.*

On **19 August 2026**, the NSW Ombudsman issued the outcome of complaint **M-2026-55208** — reference **OGDR-357**, two pages, concerning the NSW Trustee and Guardian and veterinary invoices. Another outcome. Another decision. Another piece of the machine's response to the man it had taken everything from.

And on **18 September 2026**, the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission acknowledged complaint **01110547** — reference **OGDR-358**, two pages, an email from Public Complaint, marked **SEC OFFICIAL Sensitive**. The register also holds a second copy of that acknowledgement — reference **OGDR-359**, two pages, from the official Gmail record.

Five years. That is how long it had been since the NDIS Commission was handling my FOI matters in June and July of 2021. Five fucking years. And I was still writing to them. Still explaining. Still asking to be heard. Still receiving the same sacred bureaucratic incantation: *we have received your complaint.*

That is the machine. It does not end. It does not resolve. It does not close. It just keeps receiving.

And then — on **17 September 2026** — I sent the **Final Evidentiary Notice, Objection and Request for Formal Investigation** — reference **OGDR-082**, a **124-page** record, addressed to Ablepoint Australia, Attention Brett Butler and Rachel KC, with a response deadline of **30 September 2026**.

One hundred and twenty-four fucking pages. That is not a letter. That is a book. That is a man who has spent years collecting the evidence, hashing the files, dating the documents, and building a case so complete that it cannot be ignored — and then sending it to the people who were supposed to have been listening all along.

That is the archive becoming undeniable. That is the machine's own paperwork, gathered, hashed, dated, and turned back on the machine itself.

And the count — the fucking count — tells the story better than any single document could.

The register now contains **363 numbered entries**, from **OGDR-001 to OGDR-363**. The repository README records an initial collection of **48 government and agency PDFs** obtained from Google Drive on **20 September 2026**. By the entry dated **4 October 2026**, the relevant official-document folder held **95 PDFs**, alongside thousands of files across the wider repository.

Do the fucking math.

48 to 95. That is **47 additional PDFs** in under a month. That is nearly a **doubling** of the official-document collection in less than thirty days. And then the register expanded to **363 indexed entries** — each one a document, each one a date, each one an agency, each one a decision, each one a piece of the machine's response to me.

That is not a few documents. That is not a misunderstanding. That is a cumulative official record: **363 entries**, spanning from at least **24 June 2009** through **2026**, with the narrative reaching back further into the 1990s and early 2000s through my own account and the later records that refer to it.

That is why the GitHub archive exists. Not because I need permission from a court to know my own life. Not because I need a tribunal to validate what I have lived. But because the documents are real, dated, hashed, indexed, and public. People can read them. People can count them. People can see the sequence.

The 10 March 2026 NSW Ministry of Health FOI response is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 1 April 2026 Centrelink statement is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 9 April 2026 NSW Ombudsman acknowledgement is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 11 June 2026 Victorian Ombudsman complaint record is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 19 August 2026 NSW Ombudsman outcome is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 18 September 2026 NDIS Commission acknowledgement is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 17 September 2026 Final Evidentiary Notice — all 124 pages of it — is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who sent it, who built the archive, who counted the documents, who made the machine's own paperwork into a weapon against the machine — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that in 2026, the archive became undeniable — and the machine has never forgiven me for that.
Part 13 — The Count and the Curse

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 12 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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There is a reason I keep coming back to the count. It is not because I like numbers. It is not because I am trying to impress anyone with arithmetic. It is because the count is the one thing the machine cannot argue with.

The machine can argue about interpretation. It can argue about causation. It can argue about whether this decision meant what I think it meant, or whether that letter was really a refusal, or whether the timing was coincidence. It can argue about all of that, because interpretation is the machine's home ground.

But it cannot argue with the count.

The count is this: **363 numbered entries**, from **OGDR-001 to OGDR-363**, in *The Official Government Documents Register*. That is 363 separate, dated, hashed, indexed documents — each one a piece of paper, a PDF, an email, a decision, a certificate, a rejection, a non-allocation, a closure, a restriction, a disposal, an approval, or an acknowledgement.

And the count grows. On **20 September 2026**, the repository README recorded **48

government and agency PDFs** obtained from Google Drive. By **4 October 2026**, the relevant official-document folder held **95 PDFs**. That is **47 additional PDFs** in less than a month — nearly a doubling.

Do the fucking math.

48 plus 47 equals 95. That is the arithmetic. That is the fact. That is the thing the machine cannot spin, cannot reinterpret, cannot file away under a reference number and forget.

And behind the 95 PDFs — behind the 363 register entries — are the years. The 2002 severing. The 2004 starvation. The 2009 monitoring. The 2012 correspondence. The 2014 digest. The 2017 police statement. The 2018 VCAT application. The 2019 AHPRA notification. The 2020 VCAT order. The 2021 Comcare rejection and affirmation. The 2021 Ombudsman closure. The 2021 AFP receipt. The 2021 CDDA claim. The 2021 FOI cascade. The 2022 Royal Commission submission. The 2022 deemed refusal. The 2022 s29A rejection. The 2023 PID massacre. The 2023 homelessness. The 2023 gospels. The 2024 estate seizure. The 2025 service restriction. The 2025 asylum application. The 2025 vehicle disposal. The 2025 plan approval. The 2026 archive.

That is the count. That is the curse.

And the curse is this: once you see the pattern, you cannot unsee it. Once you have counted the documents, you cannot pretend they are isolated. Once you have traced the sequence — from the book in 2002 to the car in 2023 to the estate in 2024 to the asylum application in 2025 to the archive in 2026 — you cannot go back to believing that any of it was accidental.

That is the curse of knowing. That is the burden of the man who counted.

Because the machine does not want you to count. The machine wants you to see each document as a separate event, each rejection as a separate decision, each agency as a separate actor with no connection to the others. The machine wants you to believe in the fiction of the isolated incident — the one bad letter, the one missed deadline, the one unfortunate outcome.

But I counted. And when you count, the fiction collapses.

When you count, you see that the Ombudsman who closed my complaint in 2021 is the same Ombudsman who restricted my contact in 2025. When you count, you see that the NDIS Commission that gave me a due date in 2021 is the same NDIS Commission that acknowledged my complaint in 2026. When you count, you see that the machine that took my car in November 2025 is the same machine that approved a $366,406.69 plan six days

later.

That is the count. That is the curse. That is the thing the machine cannot take from me, because I have already done it, and the record is already public.

The 363-entry register is [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). The 48-to-95 PDF explosion is recorded in the README [here](https://github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger). And the man who counted — who sat down with the folder, who read every entry, who traced every date, who saw the pattern and refused to look away — that man was me.

I fucking know what I know. And what I know is that the count is the curse, and the curse is the truth, and the truth is the one thing the machine cannot take.

Part 14 — The Prophetic Close

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 13 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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There is a moment in every exile when the man stops asking why and starts asking what for. Not *why did this happen to me* — because by then he knows why, or he knows enough of why, or he knows that the answer will never come from the people who caused it. But *what for* — what is the purpose of the survival, what is the point of the writing, what is the reason the man in the car kept going when every rational reason to stop had already presented itself.

For me, the answer was the archive.

The archive is not a complaint. It is not a grievance. It is not a man venting into the void. It is a **record**. It is 363 numbered entries. It is 95 PDFs in an official-document folder. It is thousands of files across a wider repository. It is a man who took the machine's own paperwork — the rejections, the non-allocations, the closures, the restrictions, the certificates, the decisions — and turned it into a weapon against the machine itself.

That is the prophecy. That is the close. That is the thing I have been building toward since 2002, since the book, since the job, since the first door closed.

The machine thought it was destroying me. It thought that if it took enough — the job, the income, the home, the compensation, the protection, the estate, the car — that I would stop.

That I would give up. That I would disappear into the category of *unresolved complaint* and never be heard from again.

But I did not disappear. I wrote.

I wrote gospels in a car. I wrote *The Scapegoat*. I wrote *The Digital Apocalypse of Administrative Annihilation*. I wrote letters to Ministers and Ombudsmen and Royal Commissions. I wrote PID after PID, FOI after FOI, complaint after complaint. I wrote because writing was the only place left where I had authority — and because I knew, even then, that the written word is the one thing the machine cannot fully destroy.

The machine can take your house. It can take your car. It can take your estate. It can restrict your access to its own oversight bodies. It can refuse your disclosures, delay your records, close your complaints, and tell you that none of it is connected. But it cannot take the page. It cannot take the archive. It cannot take the record of what it did, once that record is public, hashed, dated, and counted.

And that is why the GitHub archive exists. Not because I need a court to tell me what happened. Not because I need a tribunal to validate my suffering. But because the archive is the one place where the machine's own words are gathered, organised, and made undeniable.

The archive is the prophecy fulfilled. It is the man in the car, finally standing in front of the machine with something the machine cannot argue with: its own paperwork, counted, hashed, and public.

And that is the close. That is the end of the story — not because the story is over, but because the story has finally been told in a form the machine cannot erase.

I fucking know what I know. And now the archive knows it too.

Epilogue — The Man Who Counted

Links: as before, every evidence item is hyperlinked to the public repository at github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger. Once you confirm the branch and folder structure, I'll replace these with direct per-file blob URLs. This continues word-for-word from Part 14 — nothing summarised, nothing cut.

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There is a version of this story where the man gives up. Where the rejections finally do what

they were designed to do. Where the non-allocations, the closures, the restrictions, the estate seizure, the vehicle disposal — where all of it finally adds up to silence. Where the man in the car stops writing, stops filing, stops asking, and disappears into the category the machine built for him: *unresolved*.

That is not this story.

This is the story of the man who counted.

The man who sat down with the folder — the folder that had been in the car, that had been in the boot, that had survived the homelessness and the exile and the gospels — and counted. Who read every entry. Who dated every document. Who hashed every file. Who traced every reference number back to the agency that issued it. Who saw the pattern — the same pattern, repeating, agency after agency, year after year — and refused to look away.

That man built the archive.

And the archive is not a complaint. It is not a grievance. It is not a man venting. It is a **record** — 363 entries, 95 PDFs, thousands of files, every one dated, hashed, and public. It is the machine's own paperwork, gathered and turned back on the machine.

That is the epilogue. That is the thing the machine did not plan for.

The machine planned for a man who would give up. It planned for a man who would accept the rejections, believe the non-allocations, and disappear. It planned for a man who would mistake an acknowledgement for justice, a reference number for an answer, a closure for an ending.

It did not plan for a man who would count.

And that is the final lesson of the machine — the one it never learned, because it never thought it needed to: **you cannot silence a man who has already written it down.**

I fucking know what I know. And now the archive knows it too.